USER MANUAL · WORKFLOW

Workflows, tasks and forms

How work moves through Capitra: who gets each task, how to work it, how to build and change a workflow, and how forms, data fields, versions and out of office fit together. Written for everyone who works tasks, and for the workflow administrators who design them.

Version 1.2 **Date** 10 November 2026

Covers My Inbox · Designer · Workflow types · Deadlines (SLA) and alerts · Versions · Data fields · Document Designer · Automatic values · Data sources · Start a request · My requests · Out of office



0 Quick start

The four jobs people do most often. Each one links to the full explanation.

EVERY DAY

Work a task

1. Inbox (top bar) or Workspace → My Inbox
2. **Claim** the task
3. **Start work**
4. Do the work on its screen or form, then **Approve**, **Reject** or **Complete**

WHEN YOU NEED SOMETHING

Send a request

1. Home → **Start a request**
2. Choose the request (vacation, expense…)
3. Fill in its document
4. **Send request**, then follow it under **My requests**

BEFORE LEAVE

Set out of office

1. Workspace → Out of Office
2. Choose who works your tasks
3. All workflows or one, and the dates
4. **Save**: your tasks go to them while you are away

WORKFLOW ADMINISTRATORS

Make a new request type

1. Workspace → Document Designer → **New document**: its fields and layout
2. Draw the workflow, make it **User-defined**
3. Pick the document in Workflow Properties
4. Release it: it appears on Start a request

1 About this manual

The workflow engine moves work between people. Each workflow is a diagram of steps; each human step becomes a **task** in someone's inbox. When the task is done, the workflow moves to the next step on its own. The engine also keeps a full history: who did what, when, and with what decision.

PAGE	WHERE	WHO USES IT
My Inbox	Inbox button in the top bar, or Workspace → My Inbox	Everyone who works tasks
Start a request	**Start a request** on Home, or Workspace → Start a request	Everyone: send a request (vacation, expense…) and follow it under My requests
Out of Office	Workspace → Out of Office, or the button on My Inbox	Everyone; administrators can set it for others
Workflow Engine	Workspace → Workflow Engine	Administrators: live tasks and their SLA
Workflow Registry and Designer	Workspace → Workflow Registry	Workflow administrators
Document Designer and Data Sources	Workspace → Document Designer / Data Sources	Workflow administrators

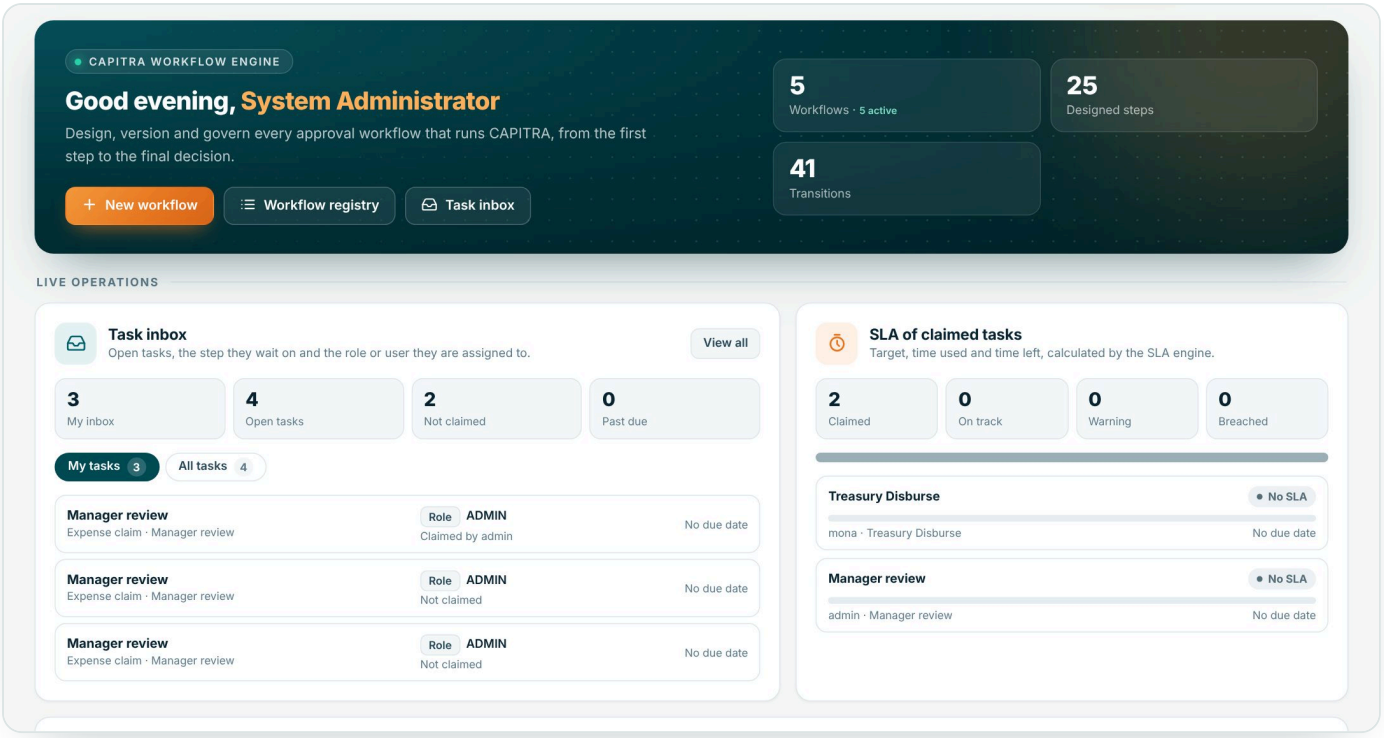


Figure 1. Workflow Engine home: how many workflows and steps exist, the open tasks and the SLA of claimed tasks.

> **NOTE** Everything in sections 4 to 6 and 8 to 9 was added on top of the existing engine. A workflow that does not use versions, data fields, documents or out of office runs exactly as before.

2 Key ideas

IDEA	WHAT IT MEANS
Workflow	A diagram of steps (BPMN) with a code, e.g. `DISBURSEMENT_REQUEST_WF`. Only a **released**, active workflow can start.
Workflow type	**System-built**: started by the system (factoring, portfolios, disbursements). **User-defined**: started by a user from Start a request, on one document (vacation, expense claim).
Instance	One run of a workflow for one business record (a disbursement, a claim). It carries its own data and history.
Step	A box in the diagram. A human step creates a task; a system step or a decision runs on its own.
Task	The work waiting at a human step, shown in the inbox of a role or one user.
Claim	Taking a task so that it is yours. A role task is visible to everyone in the role until someone claims it.
Outcome	How a task ended: APPROVE, REJECT, RETURN, COMPLETE... The arrow with the same name decides the next step.
Business screen	A Capitra page a step opens (its **Route**), such as Treasury Disburse. The task is completed from that page.
Version	A frozen copy of a released workflow. Running instances keep their version when the workflow changes.
Data field	A value each instance carries (amount, client, decision), with a type that is checked.
Document	A form designed once in the Document Designer, with its own fields and which of them are required. A user-defined workflow links one document to the whole workflow; a system-built workflow can link a document to any step.
Request	One run of a user-defined workflow, sent by a user on its document. The requester follows it under My requests.
Data source	A list of values a form's drop-down offers: users, clients, currencies, or a list you keep.
Out of office	Who works your tasks while you are away, between two dates.

3 Designing a workflow

Workspace → **Workflow Registry** lists every workflow with its code, version, status and whether it is active. Open one to edit it in the designer, or use **New workflow**.

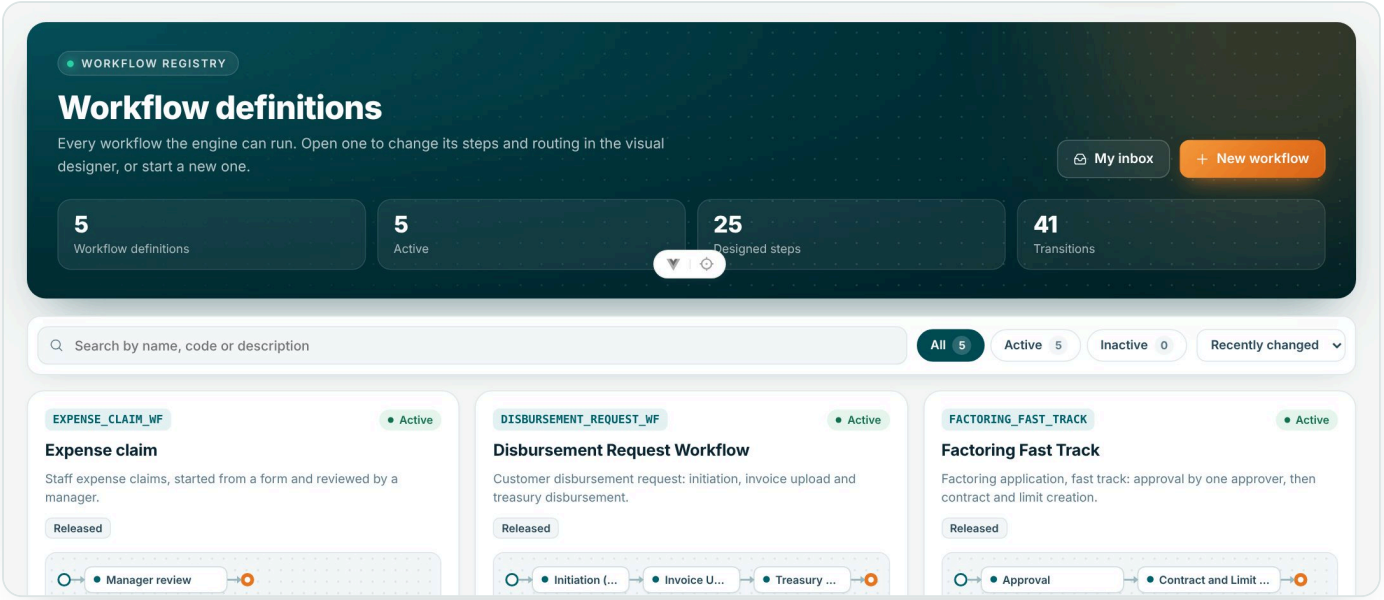


Figure 2. Workflow Registry.

The designer

Drag elements from **Tools** onto the canvas and connect them with arrows. Click an element to open its **Properties** on the right; click the empty canvas for the **Workflow Properties**. The header holds Fit, **Versions** (section 4), **Data Fields** (section 5), BPMN XML and **Save Workflow**.

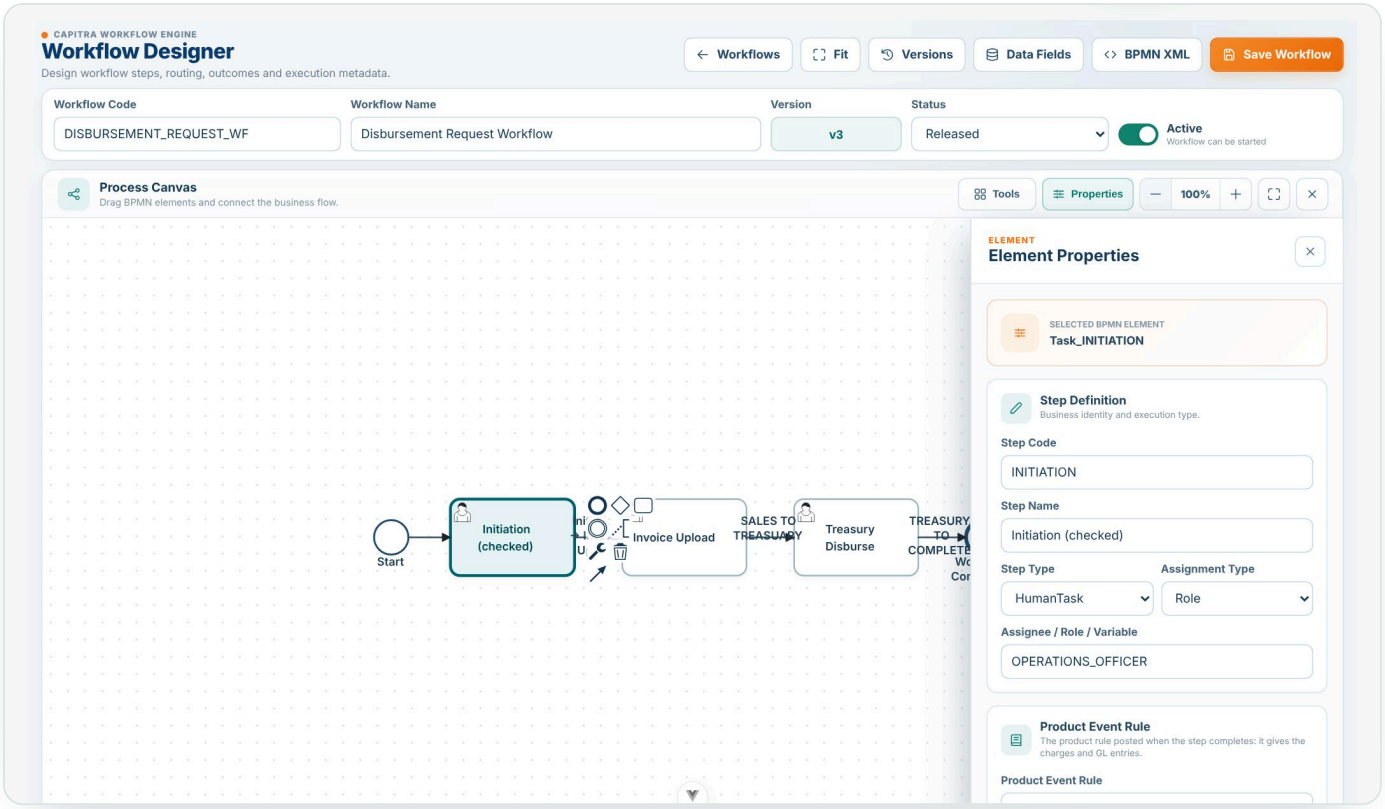


Figure 3. The designer with the Initiation step selected. The version chip shows **v3**.

Workflow type

In **Workflow Properties**, under **Workflow Type**, choose who starts the workflow:

TYPE	STARTED BY	DOCUMENTS
System-built	The system, from its module (factoring, portfolios, disbursements). Never offered on Start a request.	Optional, on any human step (step setting **Document**).
User-defined	A user, from **Start a request** (section 8).	Exactly one, for the whole workflow, chosen under **Document** in Workflow Properties. The requester fills it in; every approval step shows it read-only.

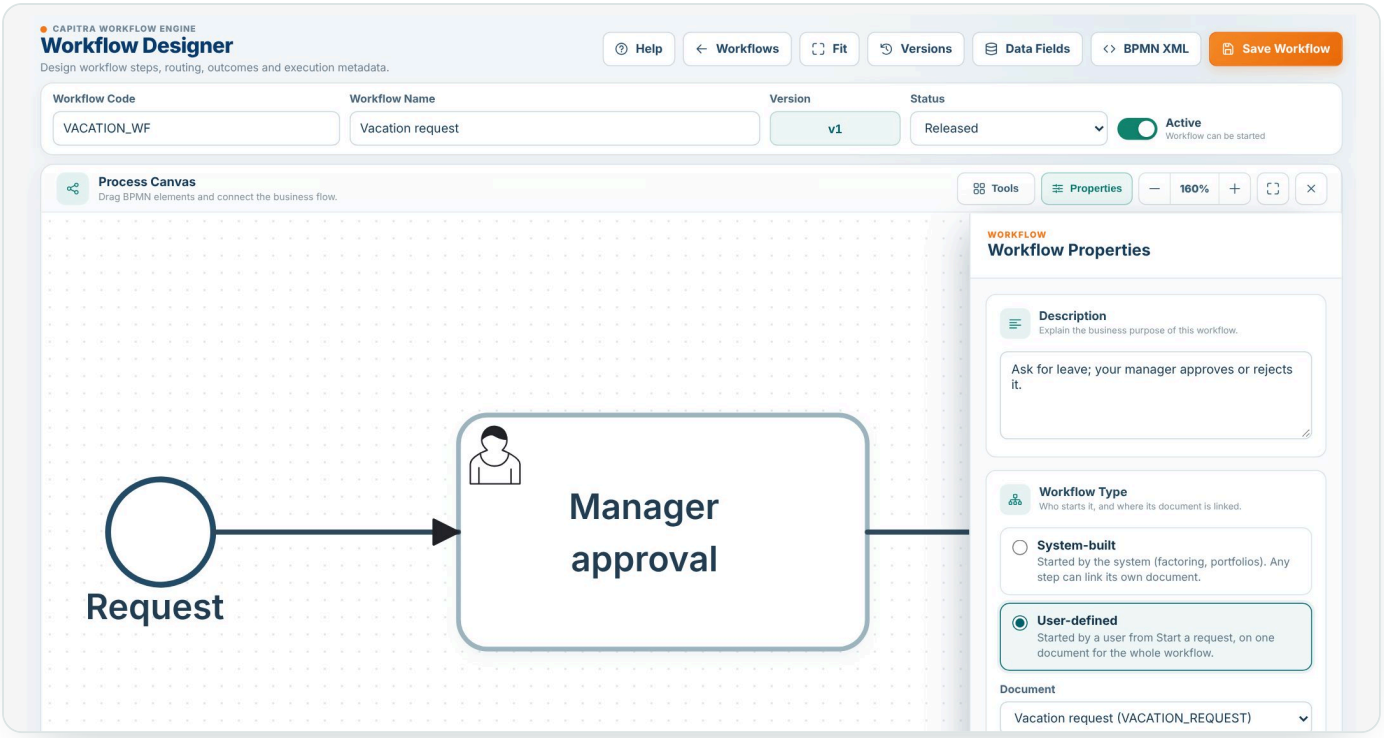


Figure 4. The Vacation request workflow is **User-defined** and uses the **Vacation request** document.

> **REMEMBER** A user-defined workflow can be saved as a Draft without a document, but it is released only once its document is chosen. Workflows made before types count as user-defined when their Start had a form, and system-built otherwise.

Step settings

SETTING	WHAT IT DOES
Step Code	A stable code such as `TREASURY_DISBURSE`. Modules recognise steps by it, so keep it once in use.
Step Name	What people see in the inbox.
Step Type	HumanTask (creates a task), SystemTask, Decision, Start, End.
Assignment	**Role** (everyone in the role sees it) or **User** (one person, by user name in Assignee).
Product Event Rule	The product rule posted when the step completes: its charges and GL entries.
Document	System-built workflows only: the document people work on at this step (section 6). In a user-defined workflow every step shows the workflow's document.
Route / Page	The business screen the task opens, with its parameters. Leave empty for a step worked on its form.
Actions	The buttons that complete the task: APPROVE, REJECT, RETURN, COMPLETE... CLAIM is the claim button, not an outcome.
Deadline (SLA)	Optional: how long the task may take, a reminder before it is due, and what happens when it is overdue (below).

Deadlines (SLA)

A human step can have a time limit. Each task of the step is then **due** at a set time, and Capitra watches it every minute: it reminds the person who has it, tells them when it is overdue, and can escalate it. Set it in the step's **Deadline (SLA)** section; the sentence at the bottom says in plain words what will happen.

SETTING	WHAT IT DOES
Time limit and unit	How long after the task is created it is due: **Hours**, **Days**, or **Working days**. Working days skip Friday, Saturday and the holidays in the Treasury calendar, and keep the time of day.
Remind the assignee	Hours before the due time. The person (or everyone in the role) gets a **Due soon** alert, and the task shows **Due soon**.
When overdue	**Alert the assignee only**: an **Overdue** alert at the due time. **Move the task (escalate)**: after the grace hours the task goes to the chosen user or role, unclaimed, and everyone involved is told. **Tell someone else**: after the grace hours the chosen user or role is told; the task stays where it is.
After (hours)	The grace period after the due time before escalating. 0 means at the due time.
To a Role / User	Who the overdue task is escalated to. Out of office applies: a user who is away is replaced by their delegate.

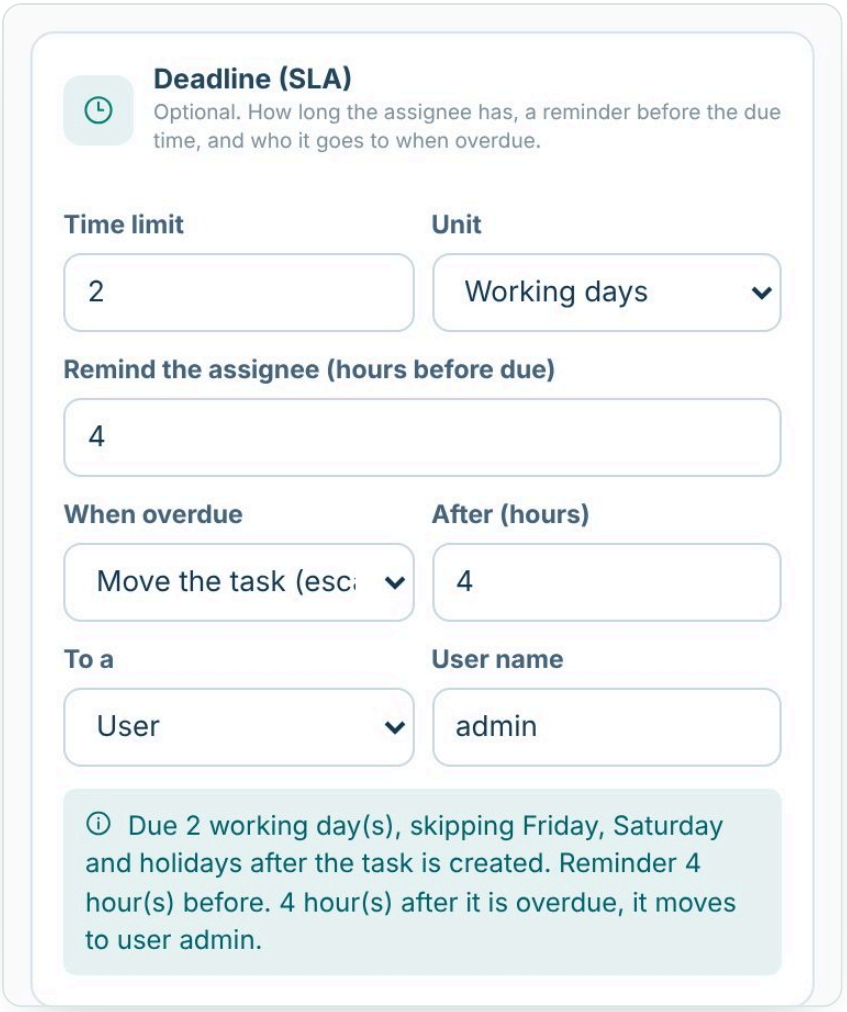


Figure 5. Manager approval is due 2 working days after the request; a reminder 4 hours before; 4 hours after it is overdue it moves to admin.

> **REMEMBER** A workflow is released only when its deadlines are complete: a time limit above 0, working days as a whole number, and a user or role when the task is escalated. A deadline applies to tasks created after the release; tasks already waiting keep theirs. A step without a time limit has no due date.

Arrows and outcomes

When a step has more than one arrow out, name each arrow after an outcome (APPROVE, REJECT). The task's outcome picks the arrow. With one arrow, any outcome follows it.

Saving and releasing

1. Set **Status** to **Released** and leave **Active** on, so the workflow can start.
2. **Save Workflow**. If the steps or arrows changed, Capitra makes a new version (section 4).
3. A Draft workflow can be saved as often as you like; it cannot start.

4 Versions

Each time a released workflow is saved with changed steps or arrows, Capitra keeps the old one as a version and the change becomes the new current version. Instances already running stay on the version they started with, so a change never breaks work in progress. Moving boxes around (layout only) does not make a new version.

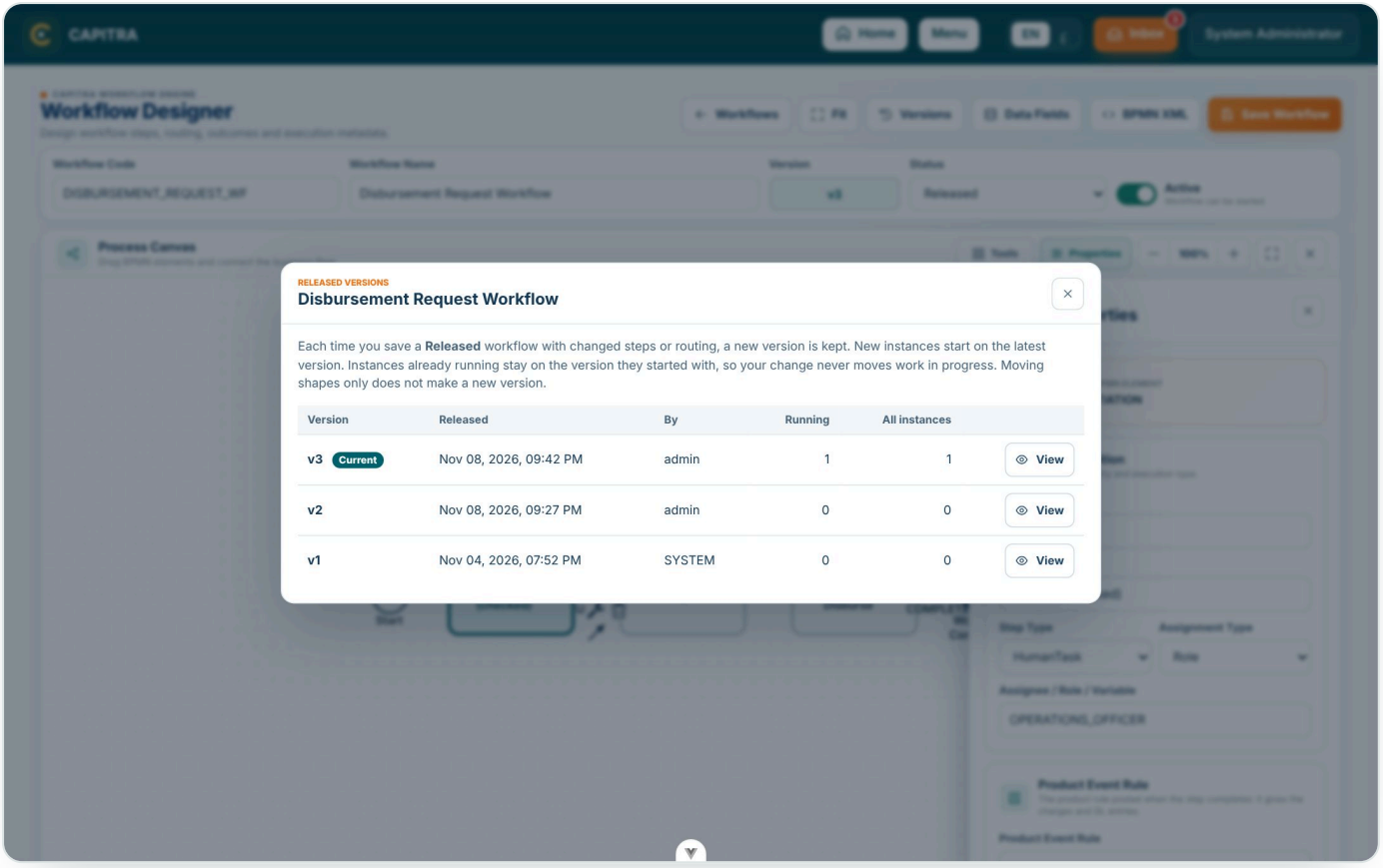


Figure 6. Versions: who released each one and when, how many instances run on it, and which is current.

- **View** opens an old version read-only. A banner says so; **Back to current workflow** returns.
- Save is off while you look at an old version.
- The version number is set by Capitra and shown in the chip beside the code.

5 Data fields

Data fields are the values each instance of a workflow carries: the amount, the client, the decision. Open them with **Data Fields** in the designer. Each field has a name (what screens and forms use, keep it once in use), a label, a type, whether it is required, a default and, for Choice, its choices.

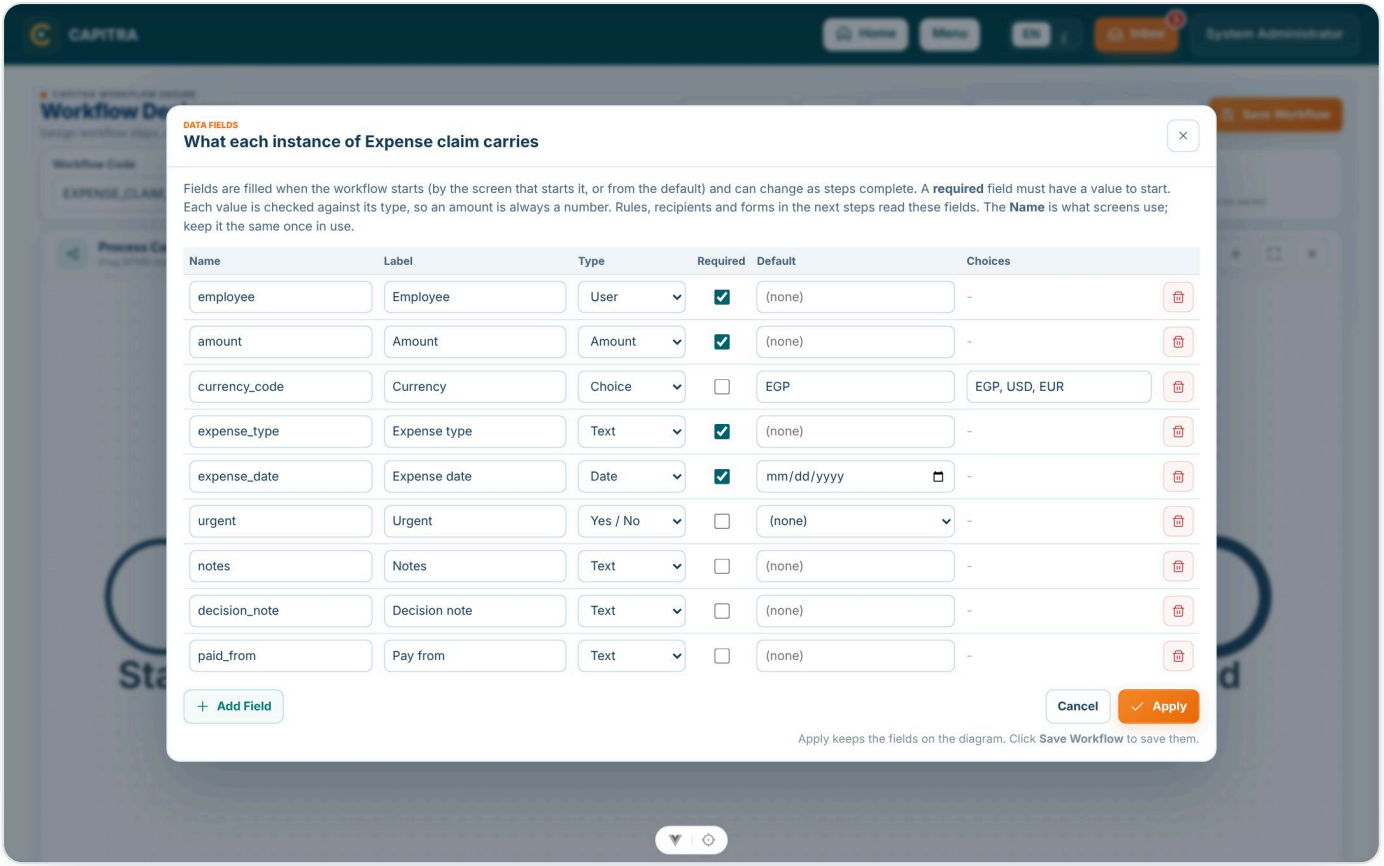


Figure 7. The data fields of the Expense claim workflow. **Apply**, then **Save Workflow**.

TYPE	HOLDS	STORED AS
Text	Any text	As typed
Number	A whole number	`1250`
Amount	An amount with decimals	`1250.50`
Yes / No	Yes or No	`true` / `false`
Date	A date	`2026-11-08`
Choice	One of the listed choices	The choice
User	A user of Capitra	The user name

- When an instance starts, empty fields take their default, every value is checked against its type, and a required field must have a value.
- When a task completes, the values it sends are checked the same way.
- The task page shows the fields under **Workflow data**.

6 Documents and data sources

A **document** is a form you design once in the **Document Designer**: its own fields, which of them are required, and how it looks. It does not belong to any workflow. Workflows link it in the designer: a user-defined workflow on the whole workflow, a system-built workflow on a step (section 3).

Designing a document

1. Workspace → **Document Designer** → **New document**. Give it a name and a code, e.g. `VACATION_REQUEST`.
2. Under **Fields**, **Add field** for each value: its label (the name fills in by itself), its type, the choices of a Choice list, a default or an **automatic value** (below), and whether it is **Required**.
3. Each field appears as a box under **Layout**. Drag the boxes to arrange the document (below). Click a box to set its label on the form, its control, its data source (for a drop-down), its width, help text, and **Read-only**. Add **Headings** and **Notes** between fields.
4. The **Preview** shows the document as people will see it.
5. **Create document**. **Used by** shows the workflows that link it.

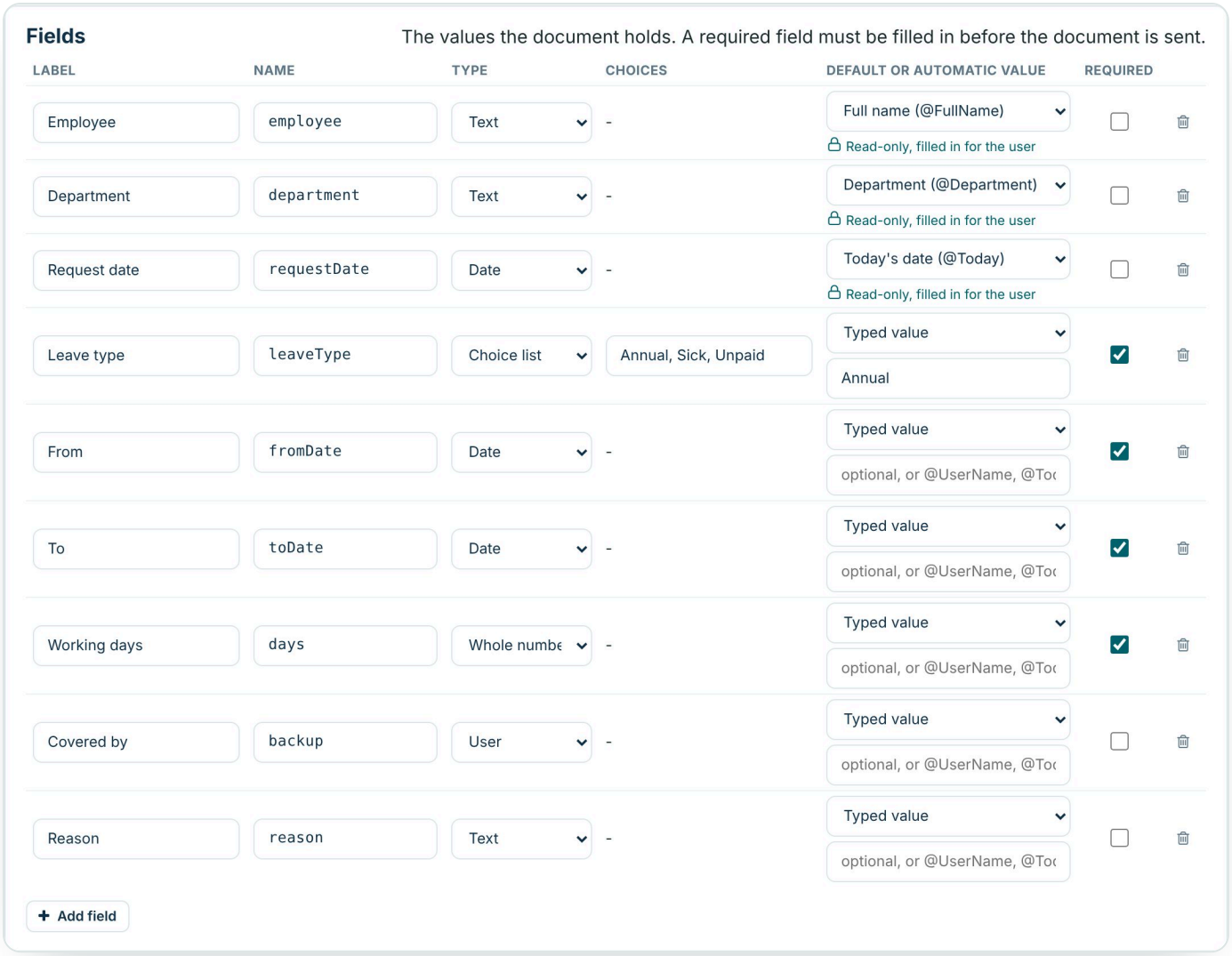


Figure 8. The fields of the Vacation request document. Employee, Department and Request date are filled in automatically.

FIELD TYPE	CONTROLS IT CAN USE	STORED AS
Text	Text box, text area, drop-down	As typed
Whole number	Number, drop-down	`5`
Amount	Amount	`1250.50`
Yes / No	Yes / No buttons	`true` / `false`
Date	Date picker	`2026-12-20`
Choice list	Drop-down (its own choices, or a data source)	The choice
User	User picker	The user name

Automatic values

A field can take its value from the system instead of the user. Choose it in **Default or automatic value**, or type its token as the default. The value is taken **once**, when the person creates the document (sends the request, or first fills in a step's document), from their login. The field is read-only, the server sets it, and it never changes afterwards: approvers cannot change it, and later steps never fill it again.

TOKEN	BECOMES	FIELD TYPE
`@UserName`	The user name of the person creating the document	User or Text
`@FullName`	Their full name	Text
`@Department`	Their department (Administration → Users)	Text
`@EmployeeNo`	Their employee number	Text
`@Today` (or `@TodayDate`)	Today's date (Cairo time)	Date or Text

Arranging the layout

The **Layout** shows each field, heading and note as a box, in the shape of the document. Drag a box:

- **Above or below** another box (an orange line shows where) to move it there on its own row.
- **Onto the left or right half** of another field to sit beside it. The document becomes two columns, the two fields share the row.
- To the dashed area at the end to put it last.

Or click a box and use the arrows in its settings: **up**, **down**, **left half**, **right half**, or **whole row**. The **Preview** follows every change.

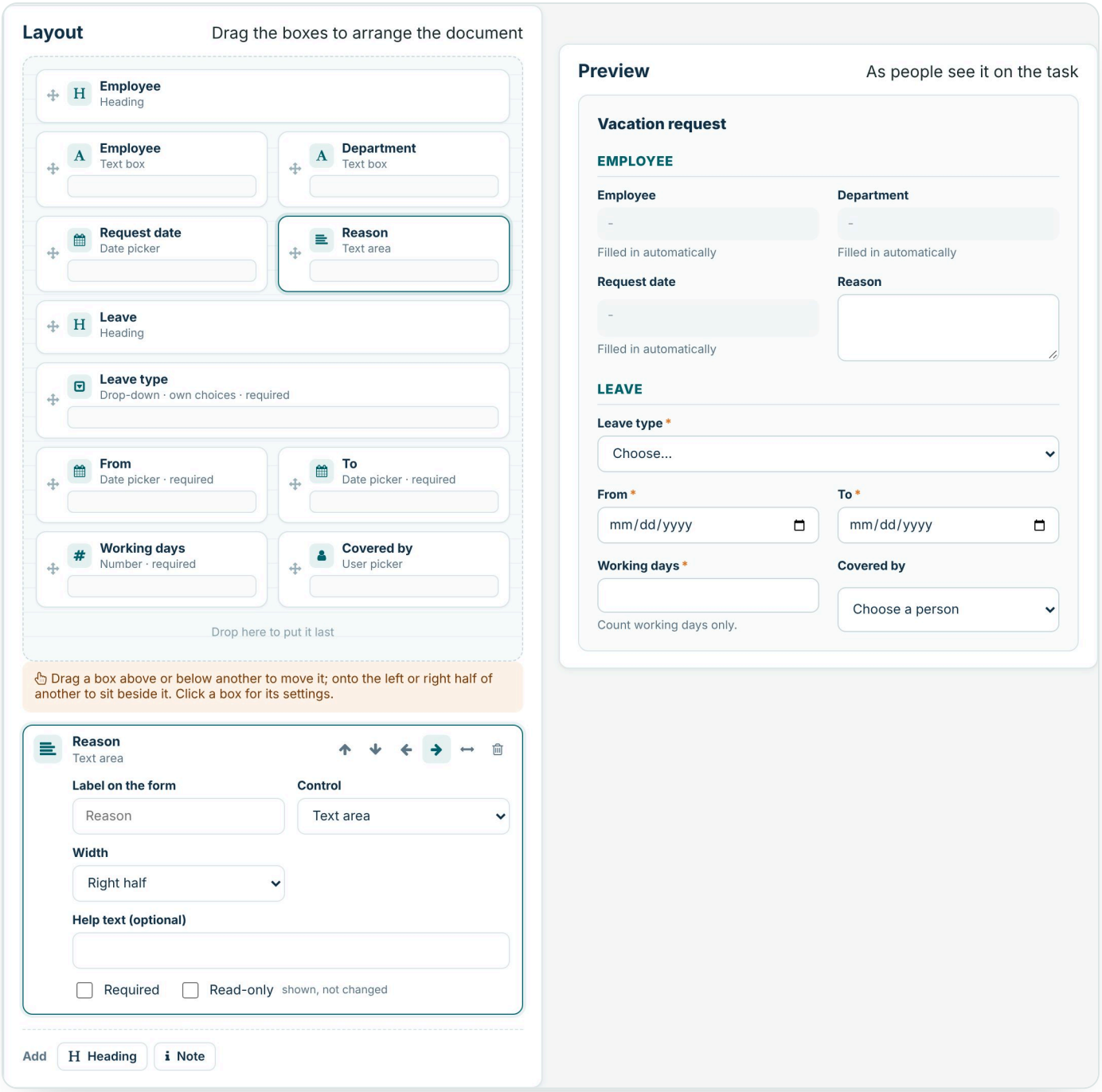


Figure 9. Reason was dragged onto the right half of Request date. Its settings show the arrows and **Width: Right half**.

Data sources

Workspace → **Data Sources**. The lists a document's drop-downs offer. Three are built in and always current: **Users**, **Clients** and **Currencies**. Make your own for anything else: a code, a name and items, each with the value that is stored and the label people see.

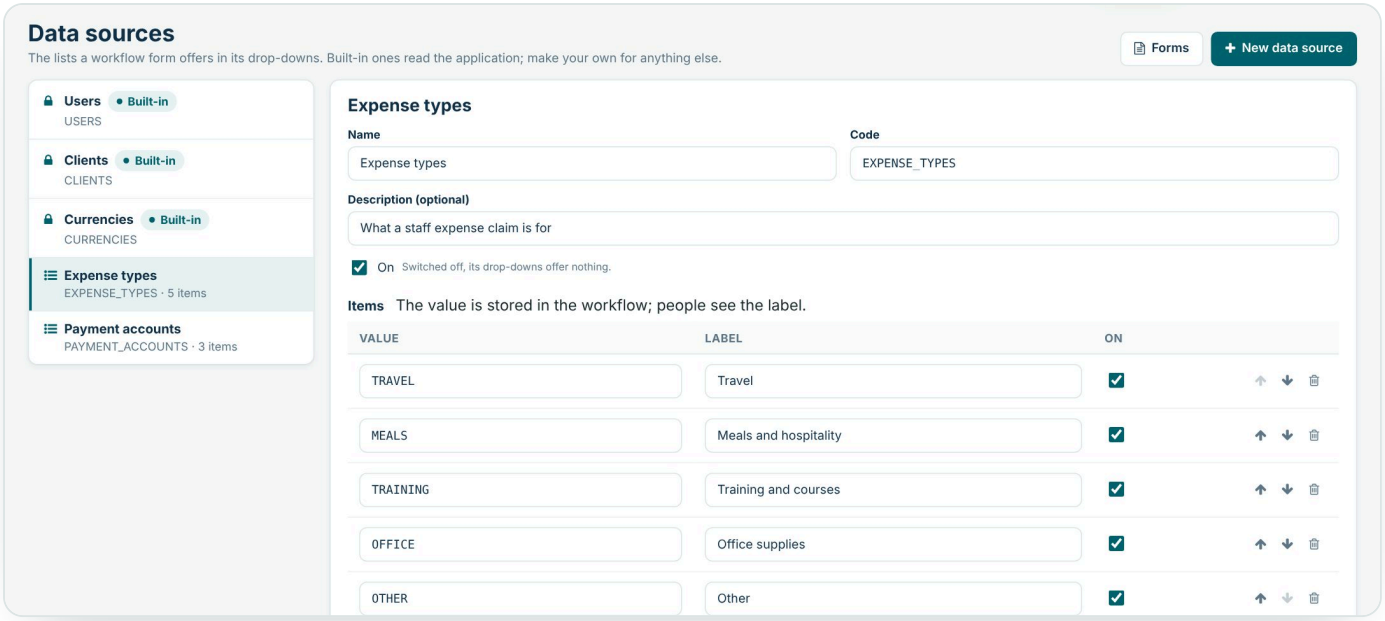


Figure 10. A data source with its items. Switch an item off to stop offering it without losing it.

REMEMBER A document in use cannot be deleted, and its code cannot change; switch it off instead. A form made before documents shows **older form of** its workflow: open it and save it once to make it a document of its own; the workflow keeps using it.

7 Working your tasks

My Inbox lists the tasks you may work: those assigned to you, to one of your roles, the ones you claimed, and those of people you cover (section 9). Overdue tasks come first. Filter by All, Claimed by me, Unclaimed or Overdue, search, or pick a workflow.

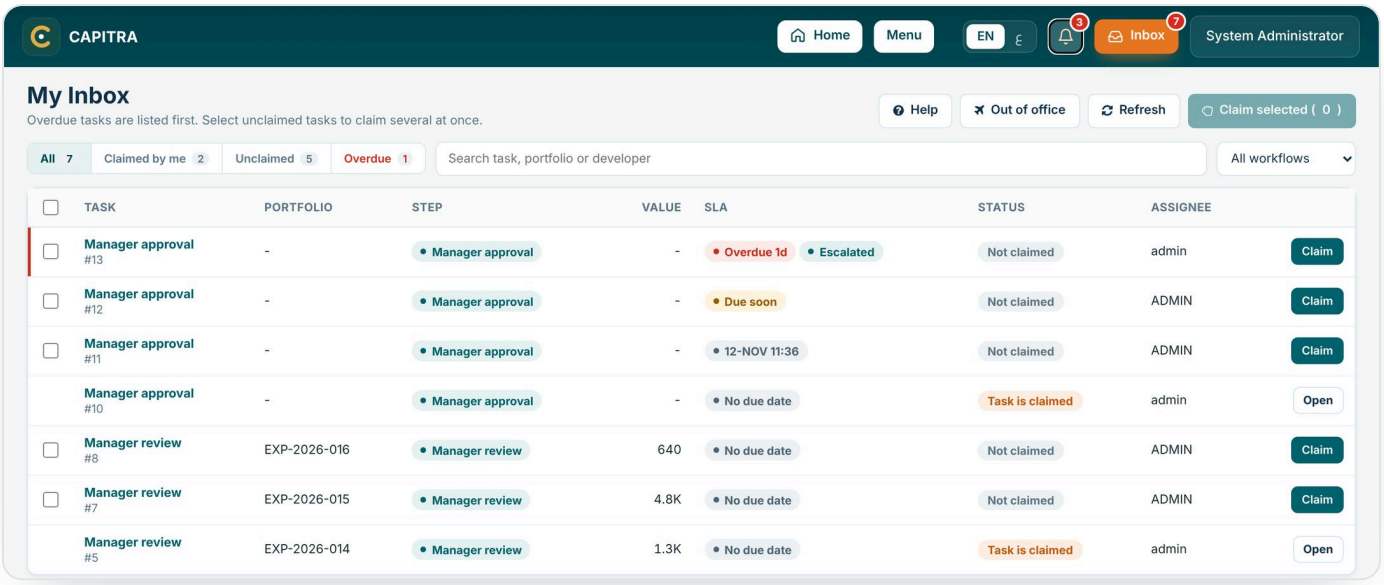


Figure 11. My Inbox. The SLA column shows each task's deadline. Tick several unclaimed tasks and use **Claim selected** to claim them at once.

The steps of a task

1 **Claim.** The task becomes yours; others in the role no longer see it. — Claimed

2 **Start work.** Opens the business screen, or opens the step's form for filling in. **Continue work** returns to the screen later. — In progress

3 **Complete.** On the business screen, or with the action buttons under the form (Approve, Reject...). Add an optional comment. — Completed

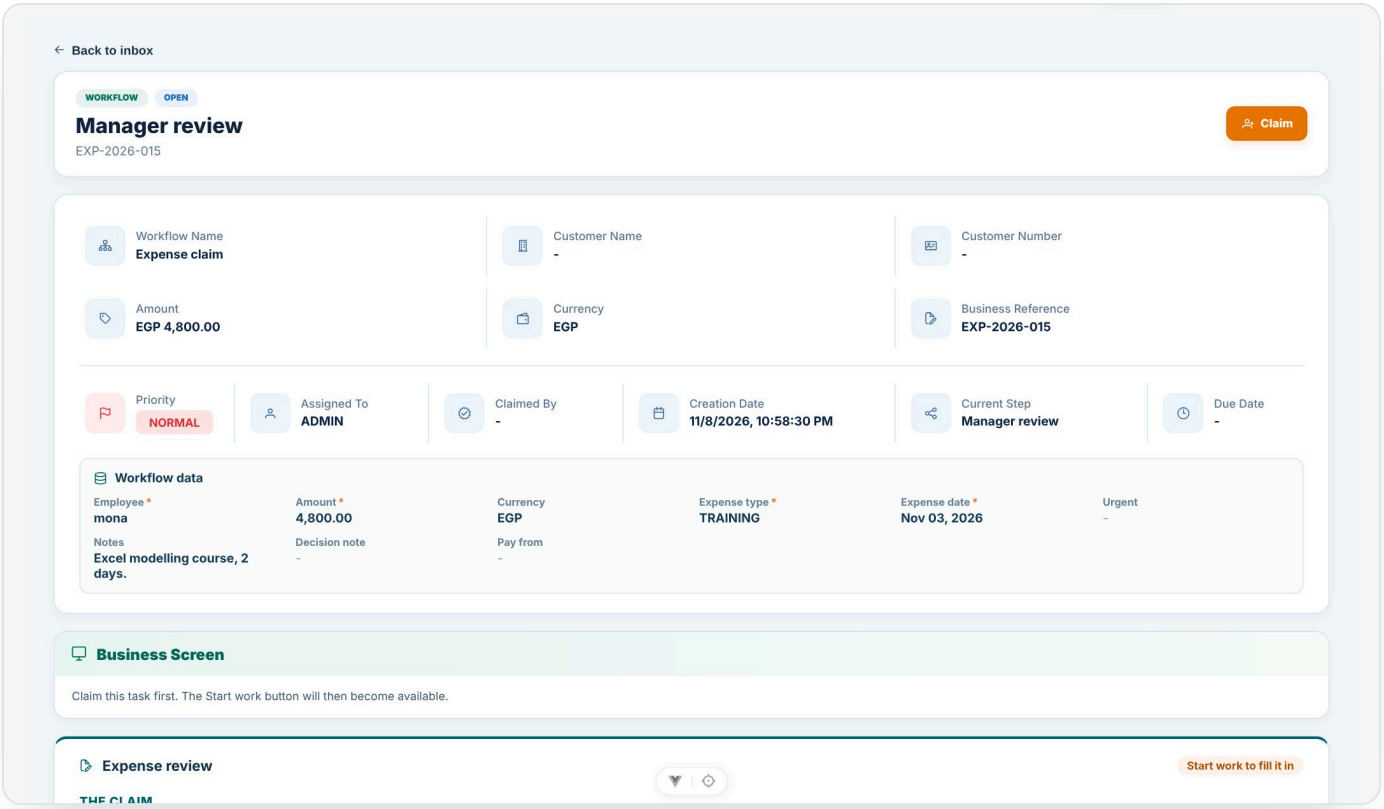


Figure 12. The task page: workflow, customer, amount and reference, who has it, and the workflow data.

A step worked on its form

After **Start work** the form opens for filling in. Required fields carry an orange star. If one is empty, the task is not completed: the message says which field, and what you typed stays on the page. Rejecting or returning a task does not need the form filled in.

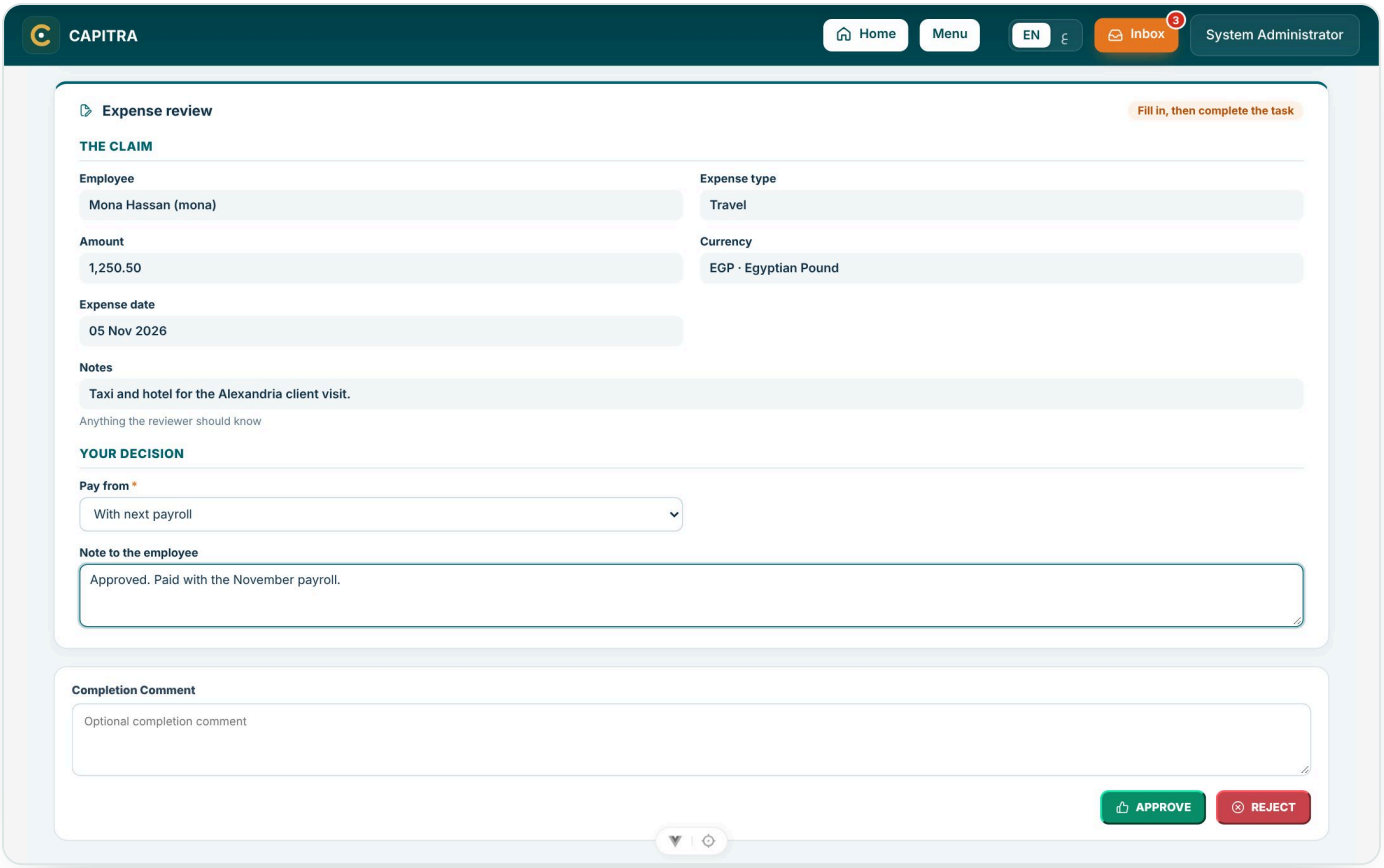


Figure 13. The Expense review form: the claim read-only, the decision to fill in.

Approving a request

A task of a user-defined workflow shows the request as the requester sent it, marked **The request as sent: read-only**. Read it, add a comment, then **Approve** or **Reject**. The requester sees your decision and comment under My requests (section 8).

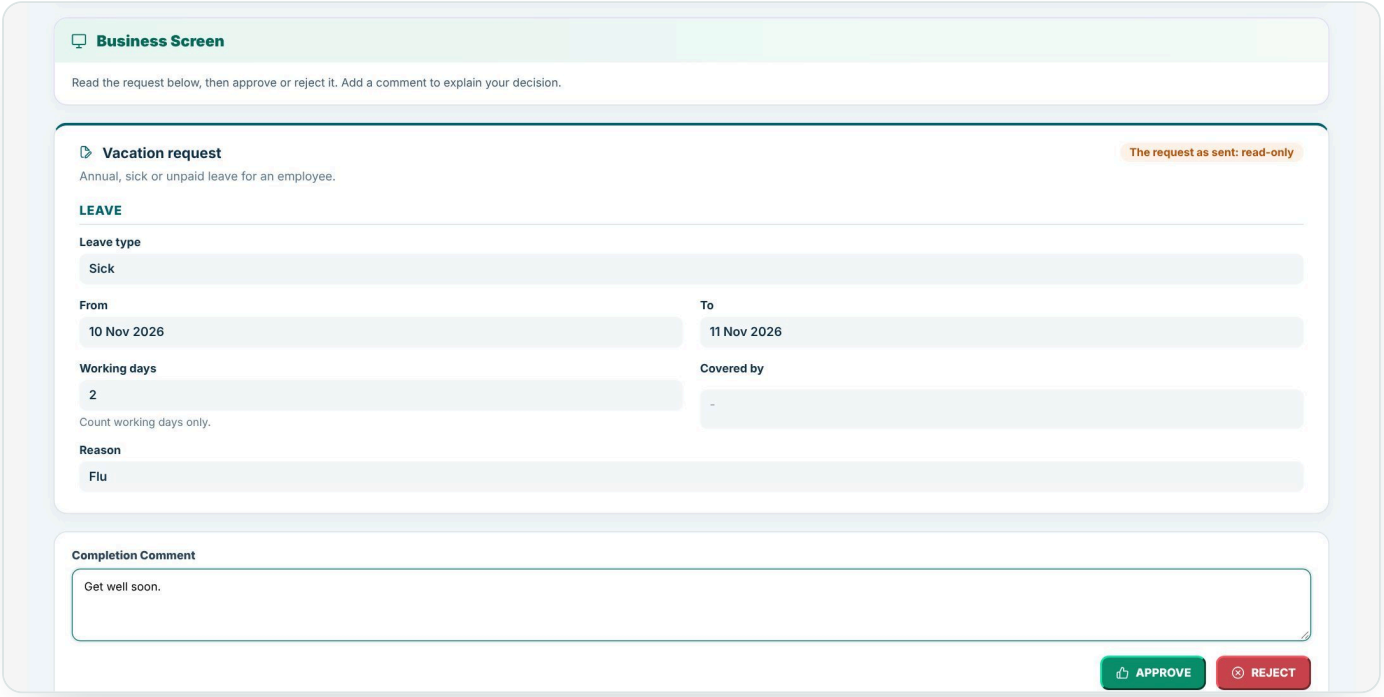


Figure 14. Manager approval of a vacation request.

Deadlines and alerts

A task of a step with a deadline (section 3) shows it in the inbox's **SLA** column and beside **Due Date** on the task page:

SHOWS	MEANS
A date, e.g. `12-NOV 11:36` / **On time**	Due then; not yet in the reminder window.
Due soon	The step's reminder time has passed (two days before, for a due date without one).
Overdue 5h / **Overdue 1d**	Past its due time, by that long. Overdue tasks are listed first.
Escalated	It was overdue and moved to you. Hover it (or see the task page) for who had it before.
No due date	The step has no time limit.

The **bell** in the top bar shows your deadline alerts and how many are unread: **Due soon**, **Overdue**, and **Escalated** (moved to you, or moved away from you). Click an alert to open its task, or **Mark all read**. Alerts are checked every minute.

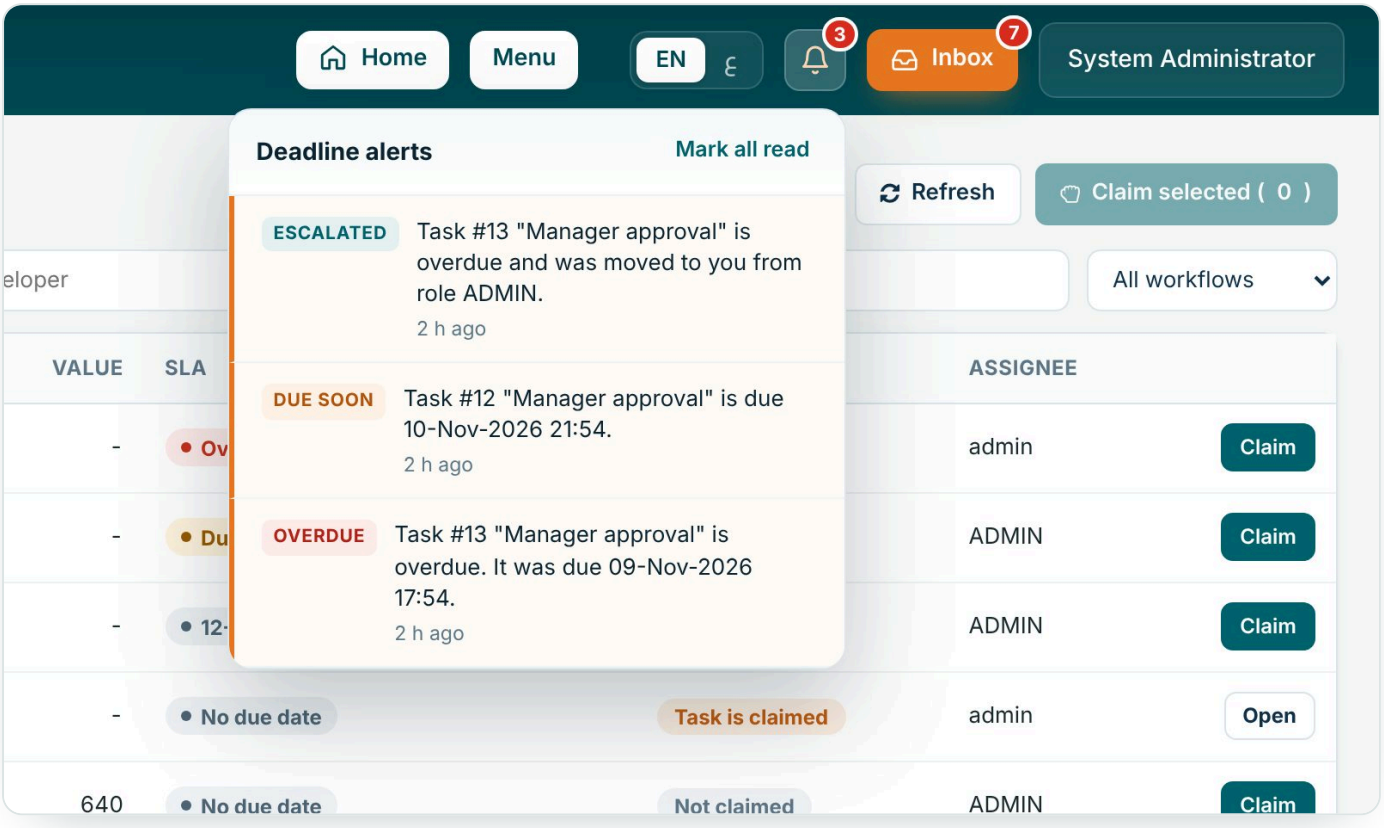


Figure 15. Deadline alerts: a task escalated to you, one due soon, and one overdue.

TIP A task finished after its due time is still completed; its history notes that it was late. Reminders, overdue notices and escalations are in the instance history too.

8 Start a request

Anyone can send a request (a vacation, an expense claim…) with **Start a request** on Home, or Workspace → **Start a request**. The page lists the user-defined workflows only; system-built workflows are started by their modules.

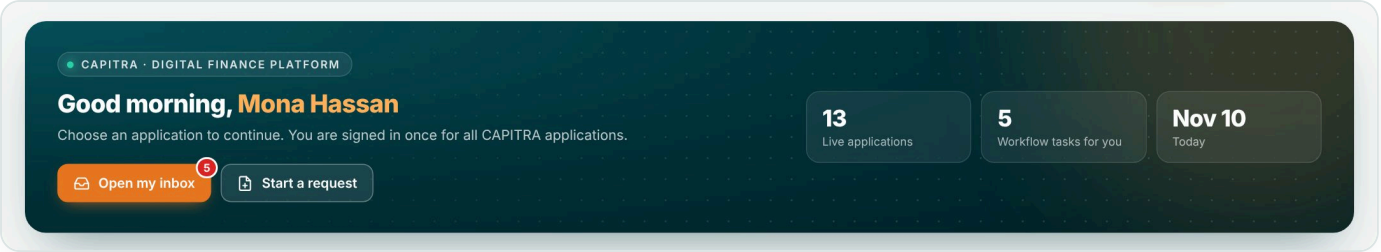


Figure 16. Start a request on Home, beside Open my inbox.

1. Choose the request on the left.
2. Enter a business reference if you have one.
3. Fill in the document. Defaults are already there, automatic values (your name, department, today) are filled in and locked; required fields carry an orange star.
4. **Send request**. The message says which step comes next and who has it.

My requests

Under the form, **My requests** lists what you sent, newest first: **In progress** with the step it is waiting at, or **Approved** / **Rejected** with who decided, when, and their comment.

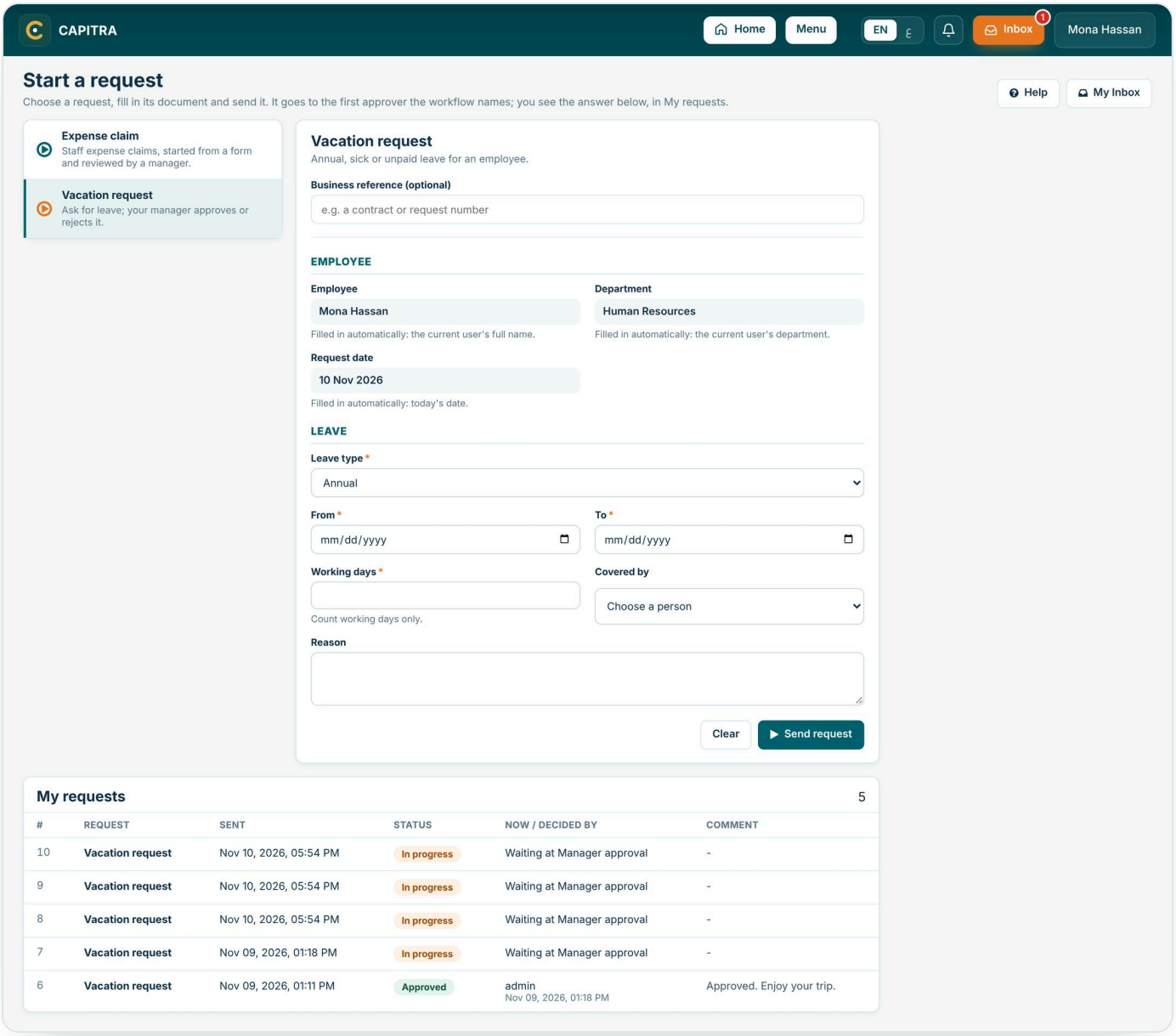


Figure 17. A vacation request: Employee, Department and Request date are filled in automatically for Mona; My requests below.

9 Out of office

Workspace → **Out of Office**, or the button on My Inbox. Choose who works your tasks, for all workflows or one, and the first and last day away. While the dates run:

- New tasks meant for you go to your delegate.
- Your delegate also sees the tasks already waiting for you and for your roles, with a **For <you>** tag, and a banner says whom they cover.
- A task you had claimed shows **Take over**: the delegate claims it from you.
- A rule for one workflow wins over the rule for all workflows. If your delegate is away too, the task passes to their delegate (up to five steps, never back to you).

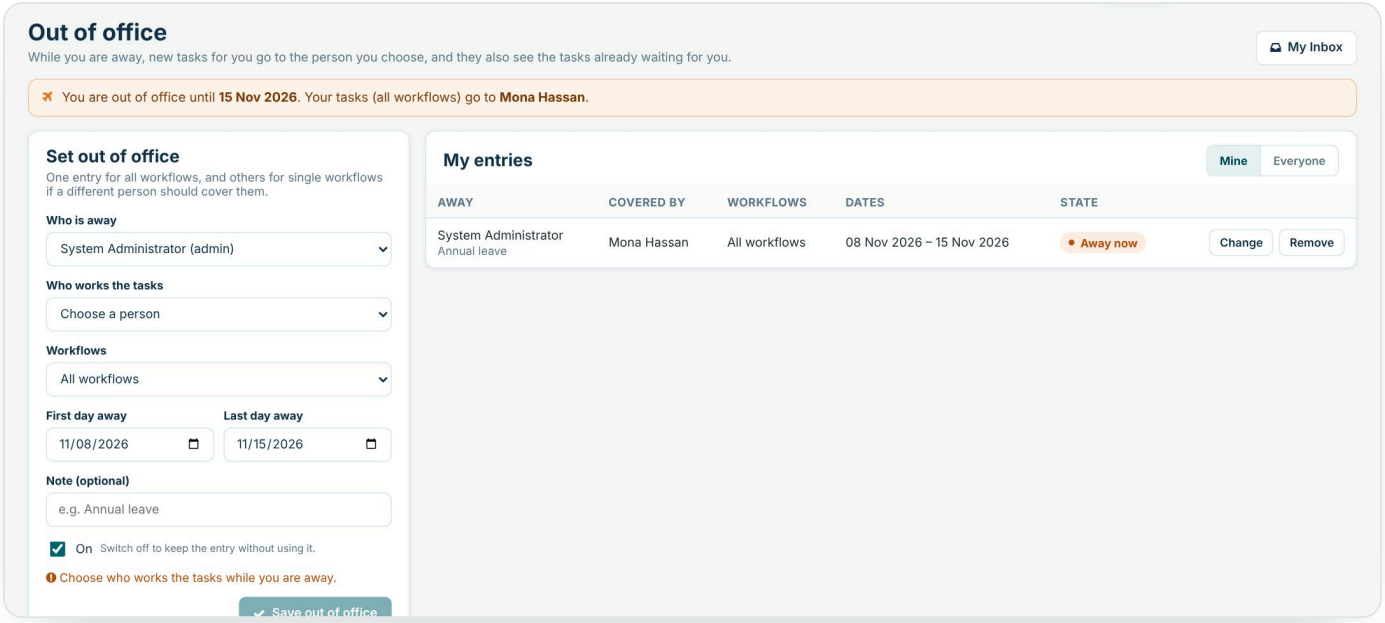


Figure 18. Out of office: the form, and your entries with their state (Away now, Planned, Ended, Off).

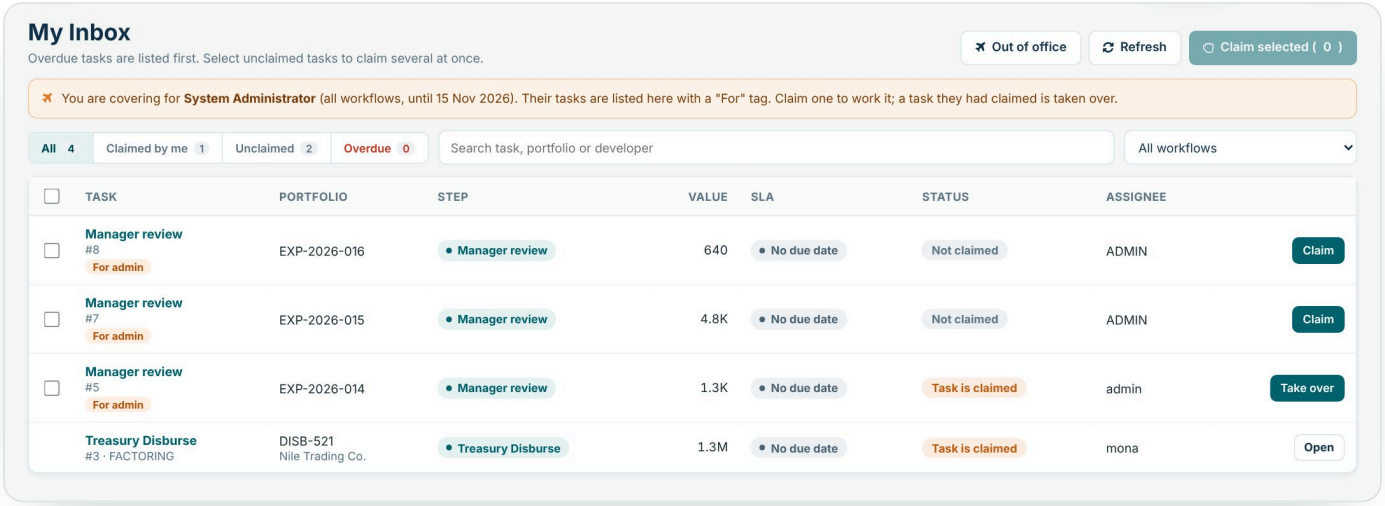


Figure 19. The delegate's inbox: the banner, the **For admin** tags and **Take over**.

TIP Switch an entry **Off** to keep it for next time without using it. Workflow administrators can choose **Everyone** to see and set entries for other people.

10 Messages and what to do

MESSAGE	WHAT TO DO
This task is not assigned to you.	Someone else claimed it, or it is not for your role. Refresh the inbox.
Fill in "...".	A required field of the form is empty. Fill it in and press the action again.
"..." must be one of the listed values.	Choose a value from the drop-down.
The workflow needs "..." to start.	A required data field has no value. Fill it in on the start form.
"..." must be an amount / a whole number / a date.	The value does not fit the field's type. Correct it.
Only a released workflow definition can be started.	In the designer, set Status to Released and save.
... is a system-built workflow. Its module starts it.	Start it from its own page, or make it user-defined in the designer.
... has no document to start it on.	In Workflow Properties, choose the workflow's document and save.
A user-defined workflow needs its document.	Choose the document in Workflow Properties, or save the workflow as a Draft.
"..." is a Choice field: list its choices.	In the Document Designer, type the choices separated by commas.
"..." is not a data field of this document.	Add the field under Fields first, or remove it from the layout.
... is used at ...	Take the document off those workflows or steps in the designer, or switch it off.
... is already out of office ... Change that entry instead.	Only one entry per person, workflow and dates. Change the existing one.
...: give the time limit, or clear the deadline settings.	A step has reminder or escalation settings but no time limit. Enter the time limit, or clear the others.

...: working days must be a whole number.	Use 1, 2, 3... working days, or switch the unit to Hours or Days.
...: choose the user or role the overdue task is escalated to.	Fill in To a Role / User, or set When overdue to Alert the assignee only.
"...": unknown automatic value "@...".	Use @UserName, @FullName, @Department, @EmployeeNo or @Today.
"...": today's date needs a Date field.	An automatic value must fit the field's type: change the type, or choose another value.

11 Permissions, statuses, glossary

Permissions

Administration → Roles

PERMISSION	ALLOWS
(signed in)	My Inbox, working your tasks, Start a request and My requests, your own out of office
`WFE.DEFINITION.VIEW`	Open the registry, designer, versions, Document Designer and data sources; see all open tasks
`WFE.DEFINITION.EDIT`	Create, change, release and delete workflows, documents and data sources; set out of office for others

Statuses

ITEM	STATUSES
Workflow	Draft · Released, and Active on or off
Instance	Running · Waiting (at a task) · Completed
Request (My requests)	In progress · Approved · Rejected · Completed
Task	Open (not claimed) · Claimed · In progress · Completed
Task deadline	No due date · On time · Due soon · Overdue · Escalated
Alert	Due soon · Overdue · Escalated, each unread or read
Out of office entry	Away now · Planned · Ended · Off

Glossary

TERM	MEANING
BPMN	The standard drawing language of the designer
Automatic value	A document field the system fills in once, from the person creating the document: @UserName, @FullName, @Department, @EmployeeNo, @Today
Delegate	The person who works your tasks while you are out of office
Escalation	What happens to an overdue task after its grace period: moved to another user or role, or someone else told
History	The record of every step of an instance: started, entered, claimed, delegated, taken over, reminded, overdue, escalated, completed
Route	The business screen a step opens
SLA	A step's deadline: the time limit to finish its task, with reminder and escalation
Take over	A delegate claiming a task the away person had claimed